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Golden Wings Names Robyn Stewart Legacy Producer as She Marks 55 Years at American Airlines

The flight attendant at the center of the award-winning documentary joins its feature expansion, *Golden Wings: Stewardess to Sky Queen*, with a producer credit she has already earned

DALLAS-FORT WORTH, Texas, September 15, 2026. Gwingz Studios today announced that Robyn Stewart, an American Airlines flight attendant since 1971, has been named Legacy Producer on *Golden Wings: Stewardess to Sky Queen*, the feature-length expansion of the award-winning documentary short about her career and her family's three generations in commercial aviation. The announcement follows Stewart's 55-year service milestone with the airline, marked in July with a commendation from American and a call from the vice president of passenger services.

The Golden Age of Air Travel is not in the archives. The stewardess colleges, the 747 rollout, the weight checks and the "fly me" ads live in the people who were there, and Stewart is still flying. The photographs survive on their own. What it felt like to walk onto a jumbo jet for the first time in 1971 survives in her.

The credit is not a courtesy. Stewart located Jock Bethune, the longtime "voice of American Airlines" who worked alongside her father on the 747 training program, and brought him to the film; his on-camera interview at the C.R. Smith Museum anchors the feature. She pointed the production toward Millie Alford, founder of the American Airlines Stewardess College, where Stewart herself trained in 1971, opening an archival thread that has since surfaced restored 1957 news footage of the college's opening day. And she remains the film's primary witness to an era no archive can reconstruct.

"I can tell you what this film is about all day, but the final judge is an audience of one, and that is my mother," said Director Caleb Mills Stewart. "She was there. She trained under Millie Alford. She flew the 747 my grandfather helped bring into service. When she said 'you should talk to Jock,' she was not making a suggestion, she was producing. The credit just makes it official."

The feature builds on *Golden Wings: Fifty Year Flight Path*, the short that began as a student project at Academy of Art University, was shot on a smartphone, and went on to win more than a dozen festival awards, including Best Short Documentary at the International Guadalajara Film Awards and the Swedish International Film Festival, Best Short Cinematography at the Silicon Beach Film

Festival, where it premiered at the TCL Chinese Theatre in Los Angeles, and Most Outstanding, Most Inspiring, and Best Trailer at NewsFest.

The feature's entry point is the Boeing 747. Stewart's father, Jay R. Ricks, a WWII navigator turned American Airlines flight engineer, helped build the airline's 747 training program ahead of the aircraft's launch. A few years later his daughter became one of the first flight attendants trained to fly on it. The film uses the airplane as a bridge between two careers that together span roughly 88 years of service at a single airline.

"Fifty-five years and I still get on the airplane," said Stewart. "Millie Alford pinned wings on girls like me and sent us out into the world. Jock worked beside my father. I have been carrying these people with me my whole career. Now they get to be on screen, and I get a say in how."

About *Golden Wings: Stewardess to Sky Queen*

Golden Wings: Stewardess to Sky Queen is a feature documentary in development from Gwingz Studios, directed by Caleb Mills Stewart. It expands the award-winning short *Golden Wings: Fifty Year Flight Path* into a portrait of one American Airlines family across three generations, from the 747 rollout to the present day, told through interviews, family archives, and synthetic-media reconstruction where period footage was lost. Learn more at golden-wings-robyn.com.

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